

Pavan Kumar Nayakanti

VP Technology Resilience | Business Continuity & DR Leader | SRE | FinTech | ITIL | 20+ Years

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EXPERIENCE

Sr. Specialist - Cloud Resilience, SRE & Platform Lead

IRIS Software - India | Clients: ADP, Charles Schwab, BMO

Sep 2020 - Present Hyderabad, India

- Defined and governed **technology resilience programmes** for ADP, Charles Schwab, and BMO -- designing SLO/SLI frameworks, crisis management protocols, and automated incident remediation that reduced MTTR by **40%+**.
- Architected **HA/DR frameworks** for BMO's on-prem to AWS migration -- RTO/RPO-aligned availability zone design, automated failover, health monitoring, and tested DR runbooks for mission-critical banking workloads.
- Scaled ADP's SRE organization from **4 to 40 engineers** -- established blameless postmortem culture, error budget governance, and Chaos Engineering (Keptn) practices that converted reactive incident response into proactive resilience.
- Built Charles Schwab's **18-member Platform Engineering team** from the ground up -- reliability gates, incident governance, and change management frameworks achieving 99.9% release reliability within one quarter.
- Designed **Cloud Platform Maturity Index (CPMI)** -- a reusable technology risk assessment and governance framework deployed across ADP, Schwab, and BMO to improve security posture, operational efficiency, and audit readiness.
- Governed **MSP and vendor resilience** via operational scorecards, SLA tracking, and structured escalation/remediation frameworks -- ensuring third-party delivery quality met client standards.
- Delivered quarterly enterprise **technology resilience and SRE training** for 200+ engineers per session -- scaling BC/DR awareness and operational maturity across three major banking clients.
- Reported resilience strategy, SRE metrics, and incident outcomes directly to **VP and C-suite stakeholders** at ADP, Charles Schwab, and BMO -- translating technical health into business-language executive dashboards.

Automation Technology Specialist - DevSecOps & Resilience Engineering

IRIS Software - Toronto, Canada | Client: Royal Bank of Canada (RBC Insurance)

Jun 2018 - Sep 2020 Toronto, Canada

- Governed enterprise-wide **DevSecOps and change management** across 250+ applications at RBC Insurance -- enforcing SOX/GDPR compliance, certificate management, patching governance, and vulnerability management at banking scale.
- Operationalized **ITIL-aligned incident, problem, and change management** across RBC -- establishing DORA metrics (Deployment Frequency, Lead Time, Change Failure Rate, MTTR) as primary engineering health indicators via Azure DevOps.
- Embedded **Run the Bank (RTB) and Change the Bank (CTB)** resilience principles -- strict environment segregation, compliant change evidence pipelines, and zero-disruption deployment cadence across 250+ apps.
- Designed and delivered the **Robo Deployment Framework** -- self-service CI/CD orchestration that reduced application onboarding from 5 weeks to **5 hours (98% cut)**; migrated 250+ apps across 60+ teams to GitHub Enterprise.
- Implemented **Splunk-based observability** and alerting pipelines -- proactive incident detection and rapid response across a 250-application estate; contributed to ~\$200K in new project acquisitions through resilience-led delivery.

SUMMARY

Technology Resilience and SRE leader with 20+ years building and governing mission-critical reliability practices for global FinTech enterprises. Designed BC/DR frameworks, scaled SRE organisations from scratch, and drove blameless postmortem cultures at ADP, Charles Schwab, BMO, and RBC -- all in heavily regulated financial services environments. ITIL-certified practitioner with a track record of C-suite resilience reporting, vendor governance, and 40%+ MTTR reduction.

KEY ACHIEVEMENTS

DR/BC at FinTech Scale
Architected RTO/RPO-aligned HA/DR for BMO's AWS migration -- automated failover, AZ design, tested DR runbooks for mission-critical banking workloads.

MTTR Reduced 40%+
Transformed ADP's incident culture -- blameless postmortems, Dynatrace + Ansible automated remediation, chaos engineering (Keptn) for proactive failure detection.

Resilience Teams from Zero
Built ADP SRE from 4 to 40 engineers; built Schwab's 18-member Platform Engineering team in one quarter -- 99.9% release reliability achieved.

Risk Governance Framework
Designed CPMI (Cloud Platform Maturity Index) -- reusable risk assessment framework deployed across ADP, Schwab, and BMO; improved security posture and audit readiness.

Automation Architect - Cloud & Resilience

IRIS Software - Toronto, Canada | Clients: Insurance & Capital Markets

Feb 2017 - Jun 2018 Toronto, Canada

- Designed **fault-tolerant, container-orchestrated deployment pipelines** using Kubernetes and Helm -- enabling zero-downtime rollouts across regulated capital markets platforms.
- Led automation delivery across 80+ applications and 250+ components, establishing reliability and recoverability standards for insurance and trading workloads.
- Contributed to **\$478K SOW closure** for a DevOps resilience engagement through delivery-evidence-backed solutioning.

Technology Manager - Enterprise Delivery & Migration

TechMahindra - Noida, India | Client: Adobe

Jul 2015 - Feb 2017 Noida, India

- Architected **zero-downtime business application migration** during Adobe's data centre relocation -- owned full execution and cutover plan, ensuring continuity across all production workloads.
- Led cross-functional global teams on large-scale enterprise delivery programmes, aligning infrastructure initiatives with regulatory and business continuity requirements.

Sr. SDET - Production Engineering & Quality

Microsoft Corporation - India

Jul 2007 - Dec 2014 Hyderabad, India

- Held dual mandate as Sr. SDET and Production Engineering owner for Sales & Marketing platforms across US, EMEA, and APAC -- sustained **99.99% uptime** over 7 years with zero customer-impacting incidents.
- Owned all non-functional objectives (availability, performance, security) -- defining resilience standards across network, infrastructure, and application tiers for global Microsoft subsidiaries.
- Managed incident response, RCA, and cross-team escalation to maintain uninterrupted service for tens of thousands of users across three global regions.

Earlier: Software Consultant / SDET / Intern

Semantic Space Technologies | DRDO | Nuclear Fuel Complex - India

Jan 2002 - Jun 2007 India

- L3 support analyst for Statusmart at CFC/Bank of America (3,000+ sales users); release management, incident management, QA, and ETL development.
- Software consulting for defence-grade, mission-critical applications at DRDO requiring high reliability and security standards.

CERTIFICATIONS

ITIL® Certificate in IT Service Operations
AXELOS

Certified SRE (iSRE)
iSRE

Azure Solutions Architect Expert (AZ-305)
Microsoft

Certified Kubernetes Application Developer (CKAD)
CNCF -- 2025

AWS Solutions Architect -- Associate
Amazon Web Services -- 2026

PMI Agile Certified Professional (PMI-ACP)
PMI

Azure AI Engineer Associate (AI-102)
Microsoft

EDUCATION

Masters in Artificial Intelligence 2024
Woolf University

General Management Program (GMP)
2022
ISB Hyderabad

M.Sc in Computer Science 2002
Osmania University

B.Sc in Electronics 2000
Kakatiya University